



Deadly WEAPONS



RATTLESNAKE

A quick bite

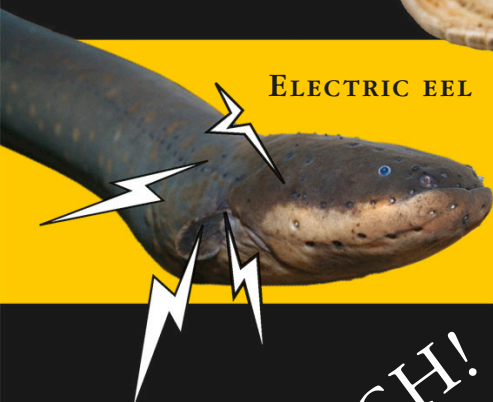
Poison is the ultimate defensive weapon for an animal under attack, but in most cases it is used to kill or subdue prey. Spiders and snakes deliver their venom by biting. Snakes have hollow fangs that allow the venom to flow from a gland in their upper jaw into their victim.

My venomous sting protects me from hungry predators—and it also kills my prey.

SCORPION



WASP



ELECTRIC EEL

Truly shocking

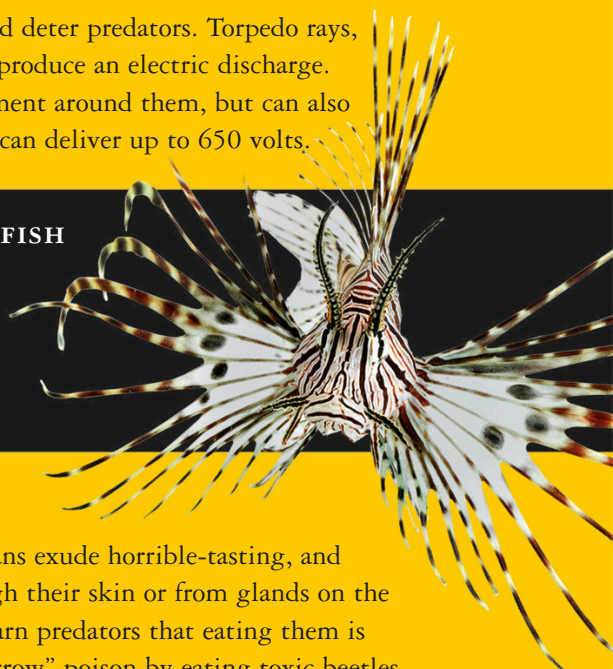
Some fish use shock tactics to stun prey and deter predators. Torpedo rays, stargazers, and electric eels have cells that produce an electric discharge. They usually use this to sense the environment around them, but can also unleash it to deadly effect—an electric eel can deliver up to 650 volts.

OUCH!



PORCUPINE

LIONFISH



SEA SLUG



Disgusting dinners

Many invertebrates, reptiles, and amphibians exude horrible-tasting, and sometimes poisonous, substances through their skin or from glands on the body. Most are brightly colored to warn predators that eating them is a bad idea. Some frogs and birds “borrow” poison by eating toxic beetles.



PISTOL SHRIMP

Get your claws out

Sharp claws that can slash an opponent deters them from coming too close. Pincers, as found on lobsters, scorpions, and crabs, are a type of hinged claw that can be snapped shut with great force. Pistol shrimp have an oversized claw that closes so fast it causes a bubble to form, creating a shock wave in the water capable of stunning both predators and prey.